

PAINTING TRADITIONS

Concept spine: support -> technique -> patronage -> audience -> school -> evidence limit
Read murals, manuscript, albums, markets and folk surfaces as different viewing worlds.

1. Reading Method

- support / surface first
- technique and pigment next
- patron-workshop and audience
- theme and style only after context
- end with one evidence limit

2. Vocabulary

- Shadanga = indigenous conceptual bank
- mural != miniature
- manuscript != album
- Ajanta: fresco secco / tempera safer than rigid true fresco

3. Rock Art

- Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar
- hunting, dancing, animals
- community memory and environment
- not a dynastic record

4. Ajanta

- multi-phase chronology
- Jataka, Buddha, Bodhisattva
- Padmapani anchor
- Vakataka-Harishena in major later phase

Ajanta: multi phase; technique caution matters.

5. Bagh

- Dhar district on Baghri river
- paired with Ajanta, not identical
- Rang Mahal = Cave 4
- Haddakaya: source-safe wording only

Haddakaya: no modern form identification; no cave contents.

6. South Murals

- Sittaravasi Jain register
- Pallava site bank
- Bhivadavara Chola memory
- Legakshi confirmation; nominal base

7. Early Portable Art

- Pala Buddhist manuscripts
- Western Indian / Apabhramsa Jain line
- palm leaf to paper shift
- Kalpasutra and Katakacharya Katha

8. Sultanate-Mughal Formation

- Nimatnama at Mandu
- Persianate = indigenous synthesis
- Humayun, Mir Sayyid Ali, Abul Samad
- Akbar and Tawfi Khana

9. Jahangir and After

- album and portrait shift
- Ustad Mansur and Abul Hasan
- Shah Jahan court portrait
- Aurangzeb-era dispersal

10. Regional Miniatures

- Deccani saturated colour
- Rajasthani court family
- Beni Thari = Kullanganah
- Basohli -> Gujer -> Kangra

Regional schools share resources but keep distinct moods.

11. Colonial-Modern Turn

- Company hybrid patronage
- Kalighat and bazaar market
- Ravi Varma oil and print public
- Bengal School, Santiniketan, Progressive group

12. Folk/Tribal Continuity

- Madhubani, Pattachitra, Kalamkari
- Warli and Gond
- community = material + ritual
- continuity through adaptation

Identify folk forms by region + material + community.